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Co-Managed vs. Fully Managed IT

Two shapes of the MSP relationship — know which one to lead with.

Overview

Fully Managed: Wired CIO is the entire IT department — no internal IT staff, or the client wants out of IT entirely.

Co-Managed: there's an internal IT person or team already, and Wired CIO supplements them — extra hands, specialized expertise (security, cloud), after-hours coverage, or a second set of eyes on things the internal team doesn't have bandwidth or skill for.

Wired CIO's Angle

Co-managed is often the easier first "yes" when a prospect already has an internal IT hire — it reduces the perceived threat of "you're replacing my job" and opens the door without a full displacement conversation.

Discovery Questions — Ask On the Call

1. Is there an internal IT person or team today?
2. What do they handle well, and what falls through the cracks?
3. Are you looking to replace internal IT entirely, or augment what you already have?
4. Where's the gap — security expertise, cloud/Azure expertise, after-hours coverage, project capacity?
5. How does the internal IT person feel about bringing in outside help — is this their idea or leadership's?

Buying Signals — Listen For This Language

- + An internal IT hire mentioned alongside a specific gap (security, cloud, after-hours, project work).
- + "Co-managed," "supplement," "extra support," or similar augmentation language.

Cross-Sell / Related Offerings

Security, backup/DR, and cloud are the most common co-managed add-on scopes — lead with whichever gap the internal team named.